

Abstract geometric lines in the top left corner, consisting of several overlapping, irregular polygons and lines in a light beige color.

UNSUPERVISED EXPLAINABLE IMAGE ANOMALY DETECTION

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Motivation

Importance: Critical for high-stakes industries (e.g., healthcare tumor identification, manufacturing quality control).

Challenges: Extreme data scarcity for anomalies; black-box models lack intrinsic explainability.

Main Idea

- Engineered an unsupervised, patch-based feature extraction pipeline.
- Leveraged a pre-trained ResNet-18 to flag defects mathematically via spatial distance, completely eliminating the need for labeled anomaly data.

Result

Achieved ROC-AUC: **0.9350** with native, pixel-precise explainability heatmaps.

LITERATURE REVIEW

RECONSTRUCTION & GENERATIVE MODELS (AUTOENCODERS, GANS)

Mechanism: Trained to reconstruct pristine images; assumes defects will cause a reconstruction failure.

Limitation: **Over-generalization.** Deep generative models are often too powerful. They successfully reconstruct the anomaly itself, reducing the error to zero and masking the defect.

ONE-CLASS CLASSIFICATION (DEEP SVDD)

Mechanism: Maps all normal data points into a tightly bound mathematical sphere to establish classification boundaries.

Limitation: **Loss of Spatial Context.** Standard models pool the entire image into a single global vector. It successfully flags a defective image, but cannot natively localize the defect.

FEATURE-BASED METHODS (THE CHOSEN ARCHITECTURE)

Mechanism: Maps localized image patches into a "nominal memory bank." Detects anomalies via direct Euclidean distance.

Advantage: **Intrinsic Explainability.** By calculating distance patch-by-patch, the spatial distance map inherently becomes the explanation, allowing for highly precise, native localization.

FEATURE EXTRACTION (VIA RESNET-18)

- Pass images through a frozen, pre-trained CNN.
- Extract intermediate layers to capture both local textures and global structures (inspired by PaDiM).

THE "NORMAL" MEMORY BANK

- Break the extracted features into localized spatial patches.
- Concatenate only the defect-free training patches to calculate the ultimate - absolute baseline of a 'perfect' product

DISTANCE-BASED INFERENCE

- Process test images through the same network.
- Calculate the exact Euclidean distance between each test patch and the normal

NATIVE EXPLAINABILITY

- Flag anomalies based on spatial distance thresholds.
- Map the patch distances directly into a high-resolution heatmap to visually isolate the defect.

APPROACH

THE FEATURE-MEMORY PIPELINE

IMPLEMENTATION & DEMO

CODE IMPLEMENTATION

https://github.com/Allison1212/i-hw-Spring-2026-mini-research/blob/main/Code_demo_final.ipynb

SYSTEM DEMO

<https://youtu.be/5FdHAq7infk>

Two thin orange lines intersecting on the left side of the slide. One line is horizontal, and the other is diagonal, crossing it.

REFERENCE

- <https://arxiv.org/html/2302.06670v4>
- https://openreview.net/pdf?id=H1lK_lBtvS
- <https://arxiv.org/abs/2011.08785>
- <https://arxiv.org/abs/2106.08265>
- <https://www.mvtec.com/research-teaching/datasets/mvtec-ad>